

The Observed Life

What I learned building dashboards for fun

The Observed Life

Pete Wall

Principal Software Engineer





The Observed Life

What's to come

Dashboard tour

Lessons Learned

Live Demo???



Classic Video Game

Bungie's Marathon



The Observed Life

MARATHON

BUNGIE™

The Observed Life



The Observed Life



The Observed Life



The Observed Life

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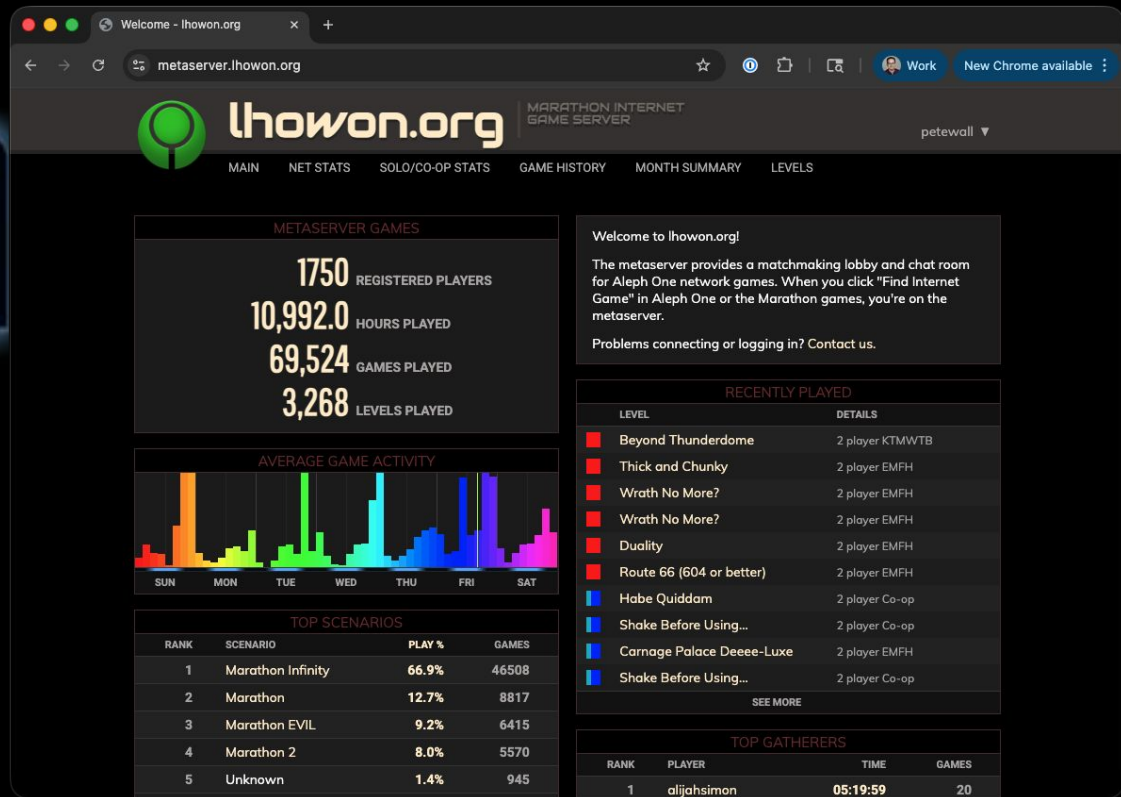


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The Observed Life

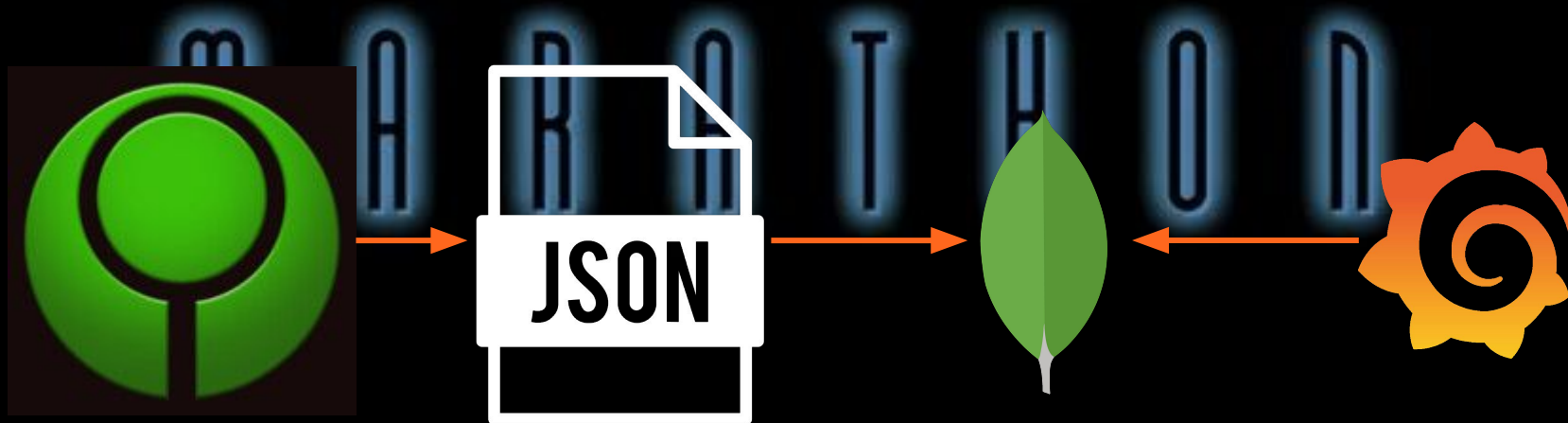


The Observed Life

MARATHON

BUNGIE™

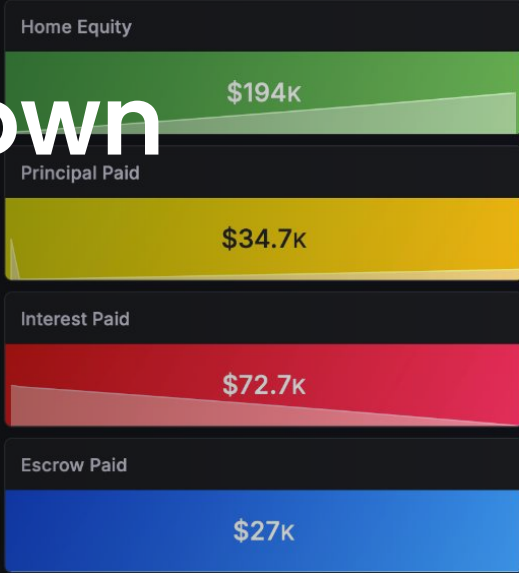
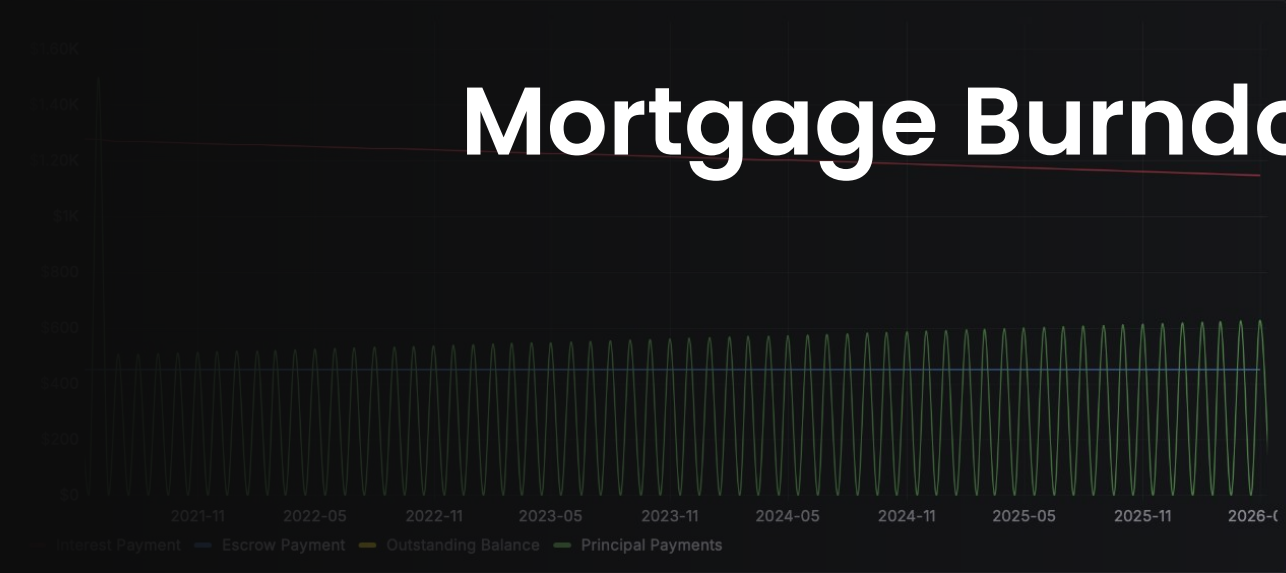
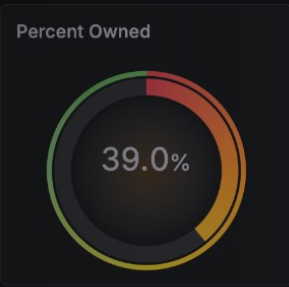
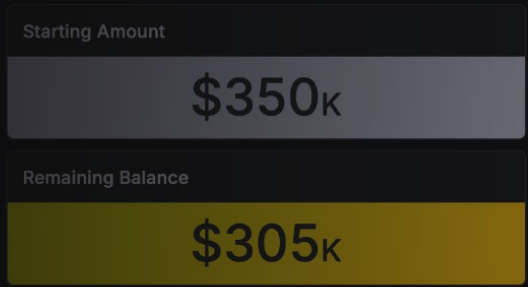
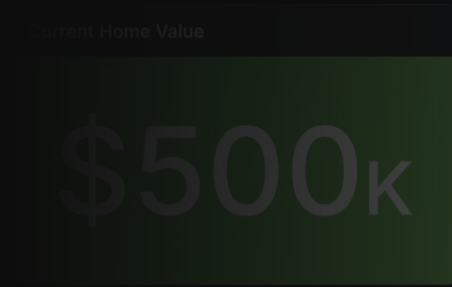
The Observed Life



BUNGIE™

Source Google Sheets Source (GitHub)

<< ⌚ Last 5 years >> 🔍 Refresh > 🔗 > ✎ Edit



Current Home Value

Starting Amount

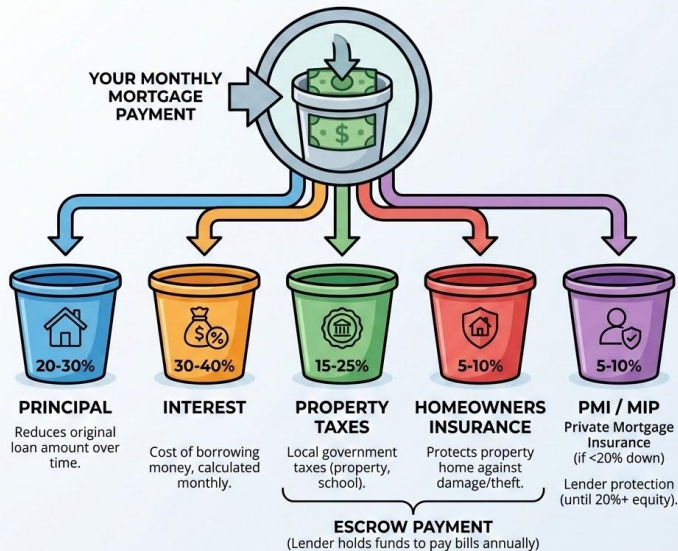
Percent Owned

\$500k

Remaining

TYPICAL MONTHLY MORTGAGE PAYMENT BREAKDOWN

How Your Mortgage Payment is Allocated



Home Equity

\$194k

Principal Paid

\$34.7k

Interest Paid

\$72.7k

Escrow Paid

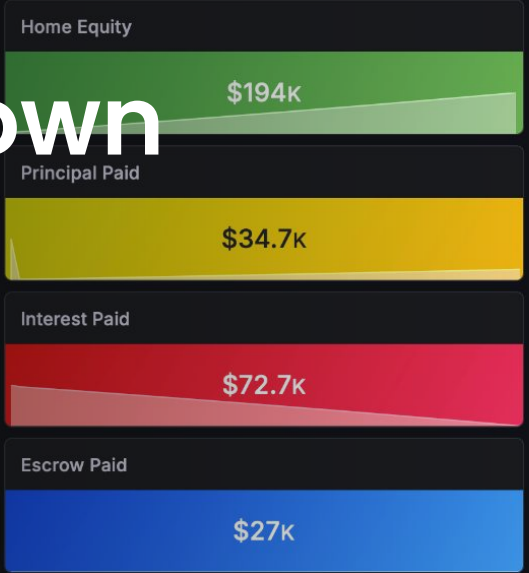
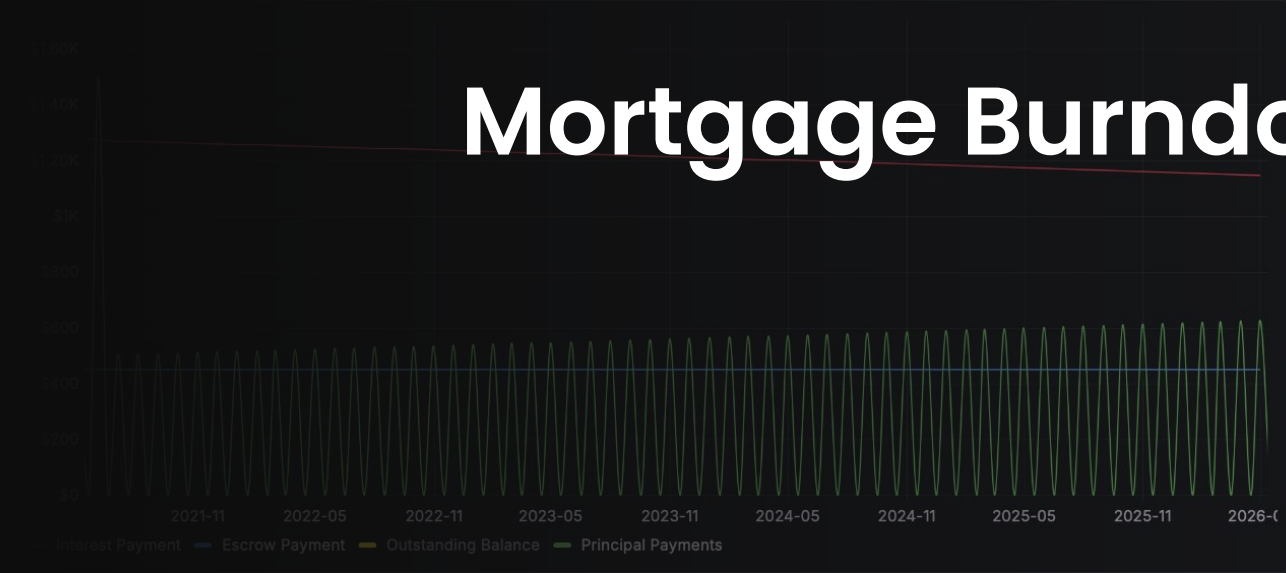
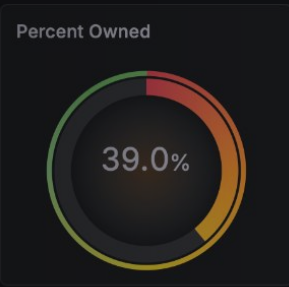
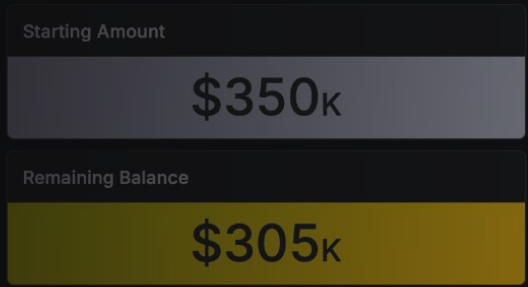
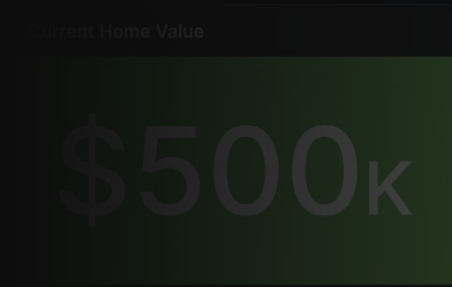
\$27k

Interest Payment — Escrow Payment — Outstanding Balance — Principal Payments

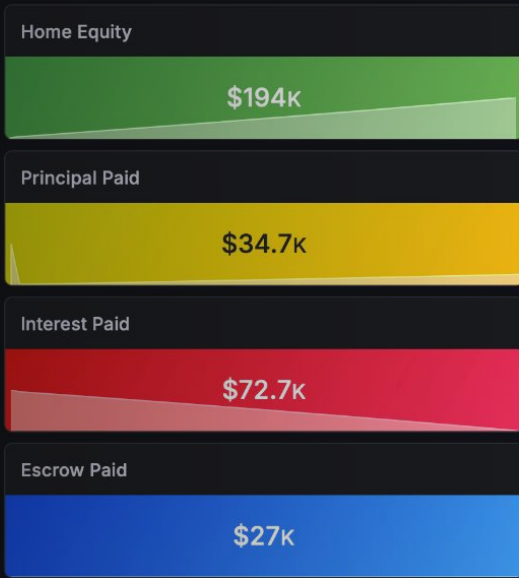
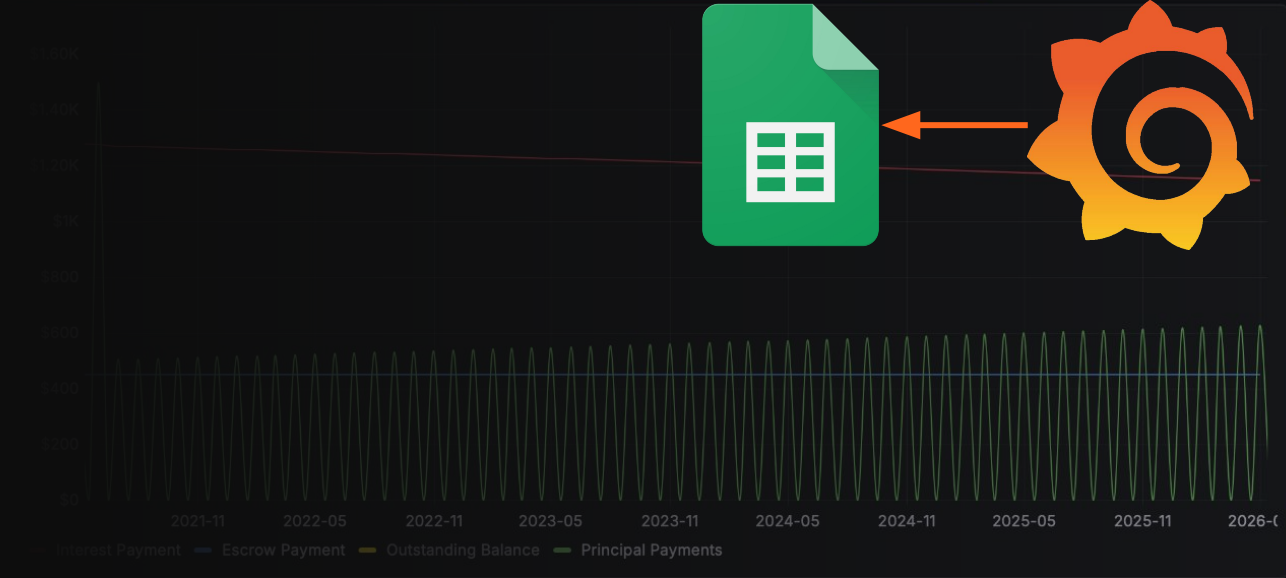
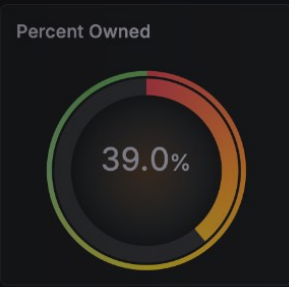
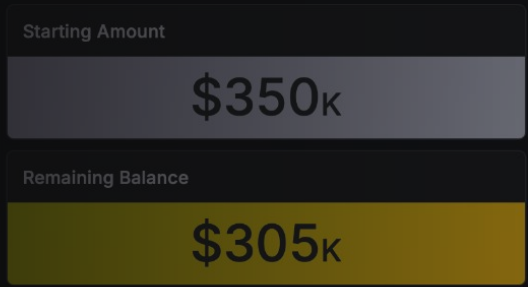
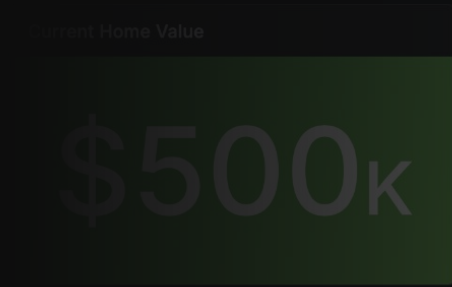
View Data

Source Google Sheets Source (GitHub)

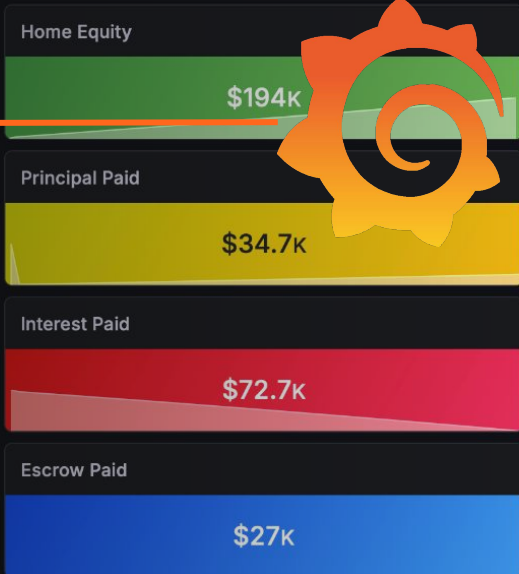
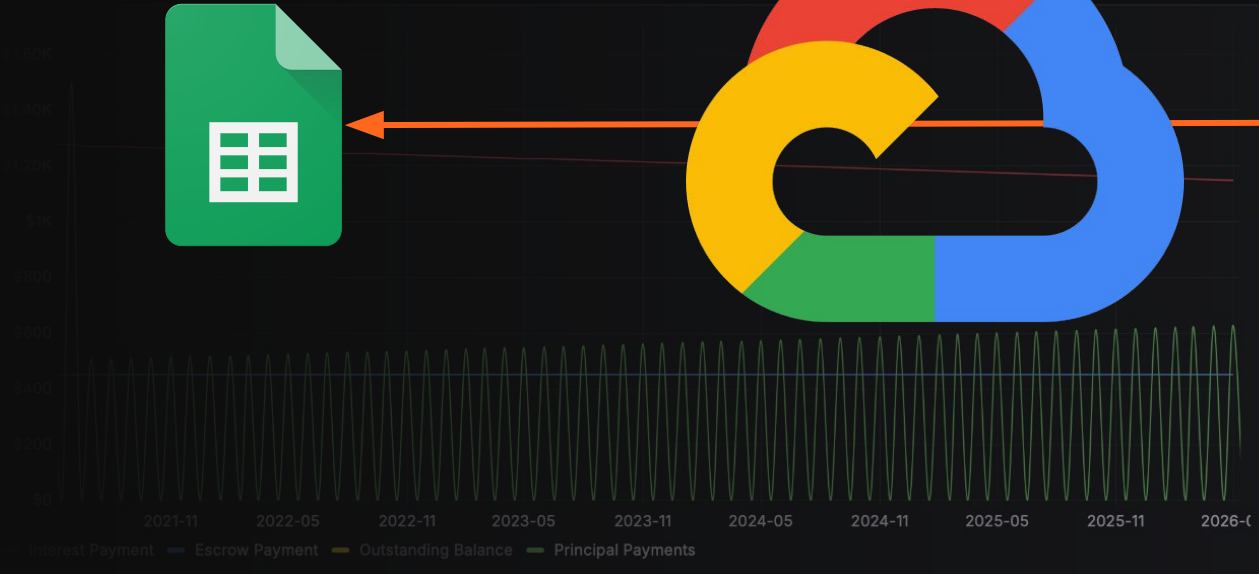
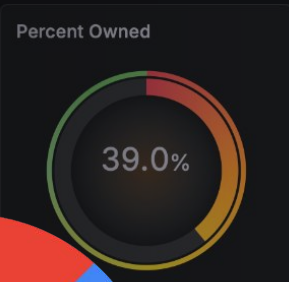
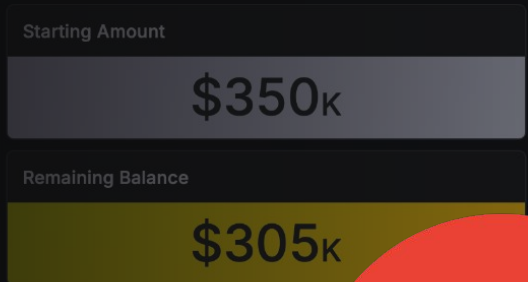
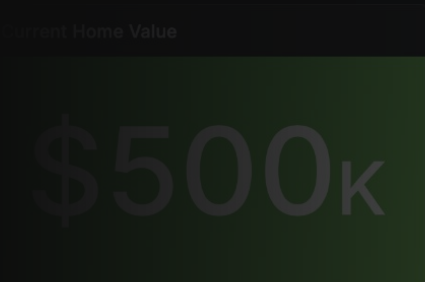
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The Observed Life (GitHub)



The Observed Life (GitHub)



Source Grafana Cloud Prometheus ▾

Source (GitHub)

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🕒

Last 24 hours ▾

>>

🔍

🔄

Refresh ▾

🔗

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Edit

Upstairs

Temperature & Humidity



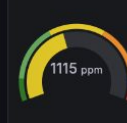
🔧 ...



💧 ...

CO₂ & VOC

☁ ...



🌟 ...



Main Floor

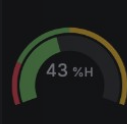
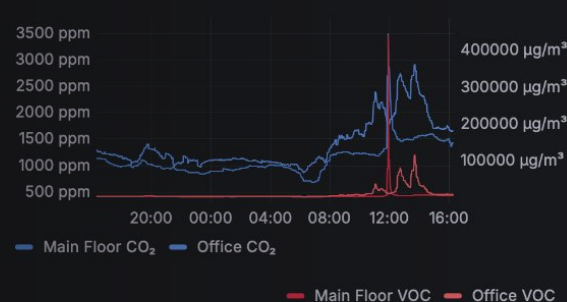
Temperature & Humidity



🔧 ...



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CO₂ & VOC

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Basement



The Observed Life

Source (GitHub)

« Last 24 hours ▾

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✎ Edit

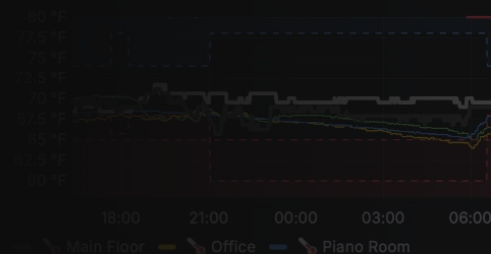
Upstairs

Temperature & Humidity



Main Floor

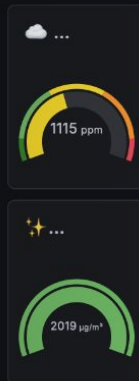
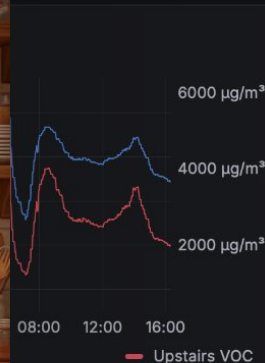
Temperature & Humidity



Basement



— 🏠 Main Floor — 🏢 Office



🔗 Source (GitHub)



Last 24 hours ▾



Refresh ▾



Edit

Humidity



Humidity



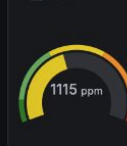
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CO₂ & VOC

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Home Climate

CO₂ & VOC

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The Observed Life

[Source \(GitHub\)](#)

Last 24 hours ▾



Refresh ▾



Edit

Upstairs

Temperature & Humidity



🔧 ...



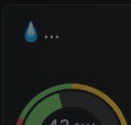
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CO₂ & VOC

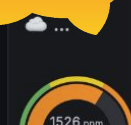
☁ ...



🌟 ...



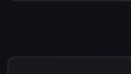
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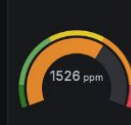
🌟 ...



☁ ...

CO₂ & VOC

☁ ...



🌟 ...



☁ ...

Main Floor VOC Office VOC

Basement

The Observed Life

[Source \(GitHub\)](#)

Last 24 hours ▾



Refresh ▾



Edit

Upstairs

Temperature & Humidity



🔧 ...



💧 ...



🔧 ...



💧 ...



🔧 ...

CO₂ & VOC

☁ ...



🌟 ...



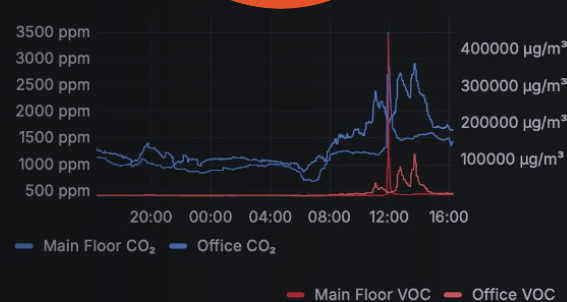
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☁ ...

CO₂ & VOC

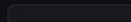
☁ ...



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☁ ...



Upstairs

Upstairs

Data Sources

Time Series



NoSQL



RDBMS



Spreadsheet



Specialized



Technical Lessons

Variables

Dashboard variables lets you avoid repeating queries multiple times

Repeating Rows

Repeating Rows lets you build big dashboards without manual effort

Queries vs Transforms

How to manipulate the data can make things a lot easier.

Datasource

Choosing the right data source can make things so much easier.



Technical Lessons

Variables

Dashboard variables lets you avoid repeating queries multiple times

Repeating Rows

Repeating rows lets you build big dashboards without manual effort

Queries vs Transforms

Know where to manipulate the data

Datasource

Choose the right data source for the type of data your working with

Creation Process

Why?

What value does having a dashboard provide?

Describe Panels

Write down what you want to see on your page, which will make it faster to build them

Sketches

Create a simple visual diagram to play around with alignment

Use AI

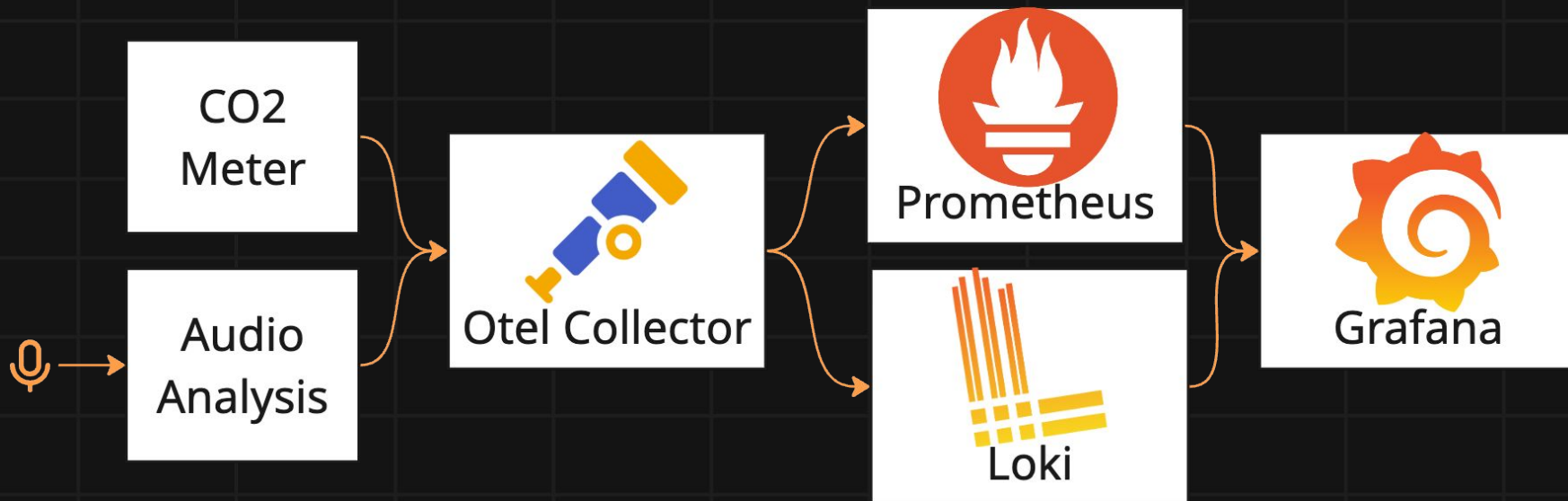
Dashboard generation has gotten so much better and is very useful for starting



AI Built dashboards



The Observed Life

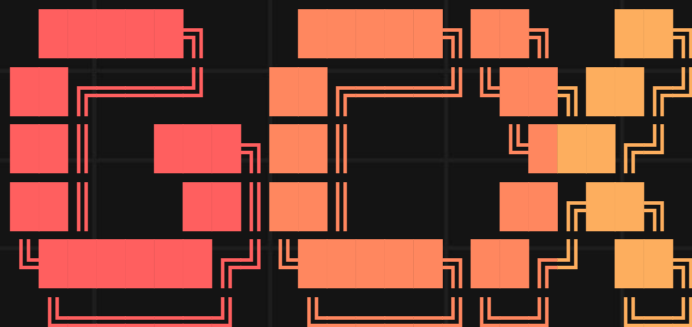


Create a Grafana dashboard called "Talk Performance"

The goal is to ...
using the Prometheus and Loki data sources



The Observed Life



Grafana Cloud CLI



The Observed Life



Grafana Cloud



Demo Repository

Stop by the Grafana Labs booth!
Chat with us about your dashboard questions!

